PATIN / TERO!

Section 7 — Game Modes, Progression, and Replay System

Game Design Document | Reconstructed Draft v1.0 | For review

Section 7 defines the available game modes, player progression, tournament replay functionality, and overall session lifecycle. PATIN / TERO! is designed primarily as a competitive, deterministic strategy auto-battler. The MVP focuses on a complete eight-player Survival League experience, supported by practice tools, battle replays, and post-match analysis. This section distinguishes MVP requirements from possible later features.

7.1 Game Modes Overview

Mode	Purpose	Scope
Survival League	Eight-player elimination tournament	MVP Core
Practice / Sandbox	Test formations and movesets without tournament consequences	Supporting
Replay Viewer	Review completed battles and analyze movement	Supporting

The MVP should prioritize the complete Survival League experience before expanding into additional competitive formats.

7.2 Survival League Mode

Survival League is the primary game mode. Eight players build rosters of runners and guards, compete in dual-arena matches, accumulate tournament points, and survive elimination checkpoints until one champion remains.

7.2.1 Core Mode Rules

• Eight participants and two simultaneous arenas per match.

• Planning and automated battle phases, character purchasing and merging, and signature moveset programming.

• Tournament points awarded from arena victories.

• Elimination progression: 8 → 6 → 4 → 2 → 1.

• Championship stage with the established shop restriction.

7.2.2 Session-Based Competition

Each tournament is self-contained. All players begin with equal conditions and develop their teams within the session. Temporary progression resets when the tournament ends.

7.2.3 Winning the Mode

Players must survive every elimination checkpoint and win the championship. Only one player is declared champion.

7.3 Practice and Sandbox Mode

Practice mode allows players to experiment with deterministic movement without competitive tournament consequences. Players may select runners and guards, set star levels, configure cards, deploy at valid anchors, run and reset scenarios, and compare formations.

7.3.2 Practice Restrictions

Practice uses exactly the same authoritative movement, collision, and tagging rules as Survival League. Practice results award no tournament points or coins.

7.3.3 MVP Scope

A basic practice environment is recommended for development and testing. A polished player-facing sandbox may follow completion of the core tournament.

7.4 Player Progression

Progression has two layers: session progression, which includes temporary roster and economy upgrades; and optional profile progression, which may retain records and achievements between tournaments. The MVP prioritizes session progression.

7.5 Session Progression

Players progress by acquiring characters, merging duplicates, expanding equipped movesets, refining formations, and preparing for championship play.

7.5.1 Character Progression

Star level	Equipped cards
1 star	1
2 stars	2
3 stars	3

Star upgrades do not persist beyond the tournament.

7.5.2 Economic Progression

Coins earned during tournament rounds are spent on characters and shop rerolls, creating choices between immediate improvement and saving resources.

7.5.3 Strategic Progression

Players also progress through knowledge: reviewing opponents, studying results, and adjusting programmed movement patterns.

7.6 Persistent Profile Progression

Persistent profiles are optional for the MVP and should record accomplishments rather than grant gameplay advantages.

Statistic	Description
Tournaments played	Completed tournament sessions
Tournament wins	Championships earned

Statistic	Description
Matches played	Completed matches
Arena victories	Offensive and defensive wins
Successful round trips	Completed runner objectives
Best placement	Highest tournament finish
Favorite characters	Most frequently deployed units
Replay history	Available saved battle records

Persistent progression must not provide extra starting coins, stronger characters, or exclusive commands in competitive play.

7.7 Replay System Overview

Because battles use deterministic simulation, they can be reconstructed from initial state and recorded configuration, supporting compact replay data and accurate strategic analysis.

7.7.1 Replay Objectives

• Review completed battles and identify effective or ineffective movement patterns.

• Support deterministic simulation debugging and future spectator functionality.

• Preserve and verify authoritative outcomes.

7.7.2 Replay Data

Data	Purpose
Match ID	Identify match
Simulation version	Check rule compatibility
Player IDs	Identify participants
Character configurations	Restore identity and star levels
Deployment anchors	Restore positions
Equipped movesets	Restore card sequences
Simulation parameters	Restore timing and rules
Random seed if applicable	Reproduce seeded behavior
Recorded results	Verify outcome

Replays need not store every animation frame.

7.8 Replay Recording

Recording begins after locked formations are finalized. The game validates formations, records initial unit and simulation configuration, executes both arenas, records outcomes and statistics, and saves the replay record.

7.8.2 Deterministic Verification

Loading a replay should reproduce the original result. A mismatch must be reported as a determinism or compatibility issue.

7.9 Replay Viewer

The replay viewer presents both arenas using the same 3D environment as normal gameplay. Basic controls include play, pause, restart, and return to results. Playback speed selection is desirable if supported.

7.9.2 Advanced Playback Controls

Optional enhancements include scrubbing, tick stepping, switching arena focus, inspecting a unit's current command, and highlighting tagging events on a timeline.

7.10 Replay Analysis

Replay analysis can show character identity and role, star level, equipped cards, current command, grid position, and execution state. Significant events include reaching row 7, turnaround, tags, TAUNT, SCARE, round trips, and arena resolution.

Post-match analysis may reveal information not shown during planning only when explicitly identified as a post-match view.

7.11 Replay Storage and Retention

Replays may be stored locally or through the multiplayer session system, depending on architecture. Local storage is sufficient for a local/simulated MVP; networked play should use authority-validated replay records. A retention limit remains to be defined.

7.11.3 Version Compatibility

Each replay stores a simulation version. Incompatible old records must be detected rather than replayed with incorrect outcomes.

7.12 Tournament History

A tournament record may include ID, date/time, participants, final standings, champion, match results, statistics, and replay references. Persistent history is supporting scope and must not delay the core mode.

7.13 Player Statistics

7.13.1 Offensive Statistics

Successful round trips, runners tagged, average completion time, frequently used runners, and offensive arena victories.

7.13.2 Defensive Statistics

Successful tags, defensive arena victories, prevented round trips, frequently used guards, and patrol effectiveness.

7.13.3 Tournament Statistics

Tournament points, 2–0 wins, 1–1 results, 0–2 losses, final placement, and championships. Statistics derive from authoritative events.

7.14 Post-Match Flow

After both arenas resolve, players review results, optionally open the replay, view updated standings, and proceed through elimination checks. Surviving players return to planning; eliminated players see a summary or spectator experience if implemented.

7.15 Tournament Completion Flow

When one player is declared champion, the game displays a champion presentation, final placements, tournament points, arena victories, successful round trips, and other highlights. Players may return to the main menu or start a new tournament, resetting session state.

7.16 Future Game Modes

Mode	Description
Casual Match	One dual-arena match without tournament elimination
Custom Lobby	Private matches or tournaments with invited players
Ranked Competition	Persistent ratings and seasonal standings
Challenge Scenarios	Preconfigured tactical puzzles

All four are post-MVP possibilities.

7.17 Game Mode Design Constraints

• Survival League remains the primary mode; all modes share authoritative movement and tagging rules.

• Practice grants no competitive rewards; replays reproduce original deterministic battles.

• Persistent progression grants no competitive gameplay advantages.

• Tournament-specific resources reset between sessions.

• Optional modes must not delay core tournament implementation.

• Replay playback cannot modify results; statistics derive from authoritative events.

• Incompatible replay versions must be detected and handled safely.

7.18 MVP Acceptance Criteria

• Players can start and complete a Survival League tournament with established elimination progression.

• Character and economy progression resets between tournaments.

• Basic practice scenarios support development testing.

• Completed battles generate replay records that reproduce original outcomes.

• Players can play, pause, and restart available replays.

• Replay records include simulation version information.

• Results and key statistics are recorded accurately.

• The champion is presented and a new tournament can start without stale session state.

Section 7 — Items Requiring Confirmation

Design item	Status
Survival League / eight-player tournament	Confirmed
Session-based roster progression	Confirmed
Persistent gameplay advantages	Excluded
Replay system	Established design requirement
Basic replay controls	Proposed MVP
Practice mode	Recommended supporting feature
Persistent profile / tournament history	Optional
Replay retention limit	To be confirmed
Replay storage location	Architecture-dependent
Advanced replay analysis / extra modes	Post-MVP

This reconstructed draft is intended for review before final implementation. Section 8 — User Interface and User Experience — builds on these systems.